

really expensive pirated software off a warez site, you are almost certainly going to be open to spyware as you do it. The same goes for some P2P clients (like Kazaa, BearShare, and Morpheus).

Gator

One of the most common spyware on the Web is Claria Corporation's (formerly Gator Corporation) Gator. Usually, Gator installs itself with such applications as DivX Pro or KaZaA. However, Gator can also install itself even if you haven't installed these programs. Most malicious Internet advertising will guide you to some or the other "free" software download. And if you do download such software, nine times out of ten, Gator will be installed on your computer without your knowledge.



Links like this usually lead to a Gator installation

Spyware can get installed on your computer when you install certain software, through the ActiveX controls of malicious Web sites, or even through pop-up advertising. ActiveX is a technology used by Microsoft IE, and it allows different applications—or parts of them—that you installed on your computer to be accessed by your browser to display content. Some spyware developers are particularly cunning, disguising their spyware